

Seeding to Succeed: First-Time Deals | 2021 Trends

In collaboration with SFC Capital, we've revisited the data on companies raising their first rounds of financing. These transactions are a bellwether for the overall health of the UK's startup and scaleup ecosystem.

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Seeding to Succeed: First-time Deals 2021 Trends

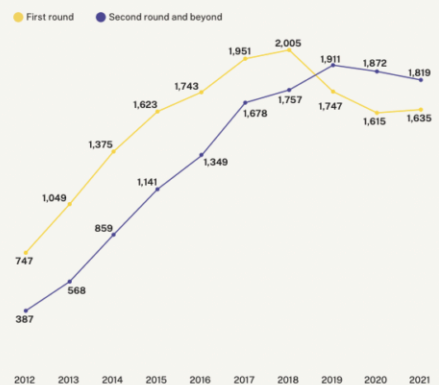
April 2022

First-time deals and SEIS

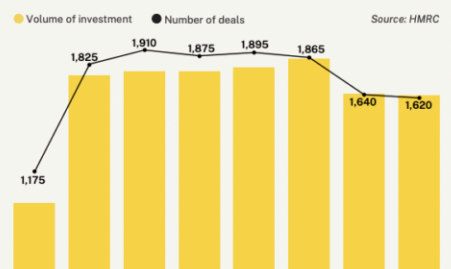
In 2021, the number of initial deals in the seed-stage increased while the number of second deals and beyond declined, drawing the two figures close to converging again. The pandemic and changes to both everyday life and business activities triggered a flurry of innovation; the 2021 increase in seed-stage initial deals may be a sign of investors beginning to be ready to tap into this new entrepreneurship.

This early-stage funding is vital for young businesses to start growing. Early finance allows companies to work on product development, conduct market research, and take on their first key staff. Initial investment into new businesses as the economy began its recovery in 2021 was and remains vital.

Number of seed-stage equity deals by round number (2012-2021)



SEIS trends by companies raising first time deals (2012-2021)



"SEIS has been instrumental in helping to get some of the UK's best tech startups funded. But because of changes in the economy it needs to be expanded to keep pace with the needs of the next generation of startups. Hopefully – amongst other changes – we will see the company allowance increased soon."

Source: HMRC

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HENRY WHORWOOD

Henry leads Beauhurst's Research & Consultancy, and is an expert on equity finance and high-growth business. He has worked on briefs for clients including Barclays, SyndicateRoom, Innovate UK, Smith & Williamson and the British Business Bank. He regularly gives presentations on finance and market trends at events around the UK. Henry studied Classics at the University of Oxford.

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DANIEL ROBINSON

Daniel conducts data manipulation, visualisation and analysis as part of the Research & Consultancy team. He has a background in business analysis and commercial copywriting in Australia and the



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ALICE WILLIAMS

Alice executes statistical analysis and data visualisation for the Research & Consultancy team. Prior to joining Beauhurst, Alice read Law at Durham University, where she acquired both an undergraduate degree (LLB) and a Masters of Jurisprudence.

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